Covinventory ERP

Comprehensive User Manual & Standard Operating Procedures Guide

An official step-by-step operational guide covering Point of Sale (POS) fast billing, inventory logistics, financial accounting, banking, GST compliance, and system administration.

Application Name: Covinventory Enterprise ERP	**Document Type:** User Manual & Operations Guide
Document Version: 2.4.0 (Enterprise)	**Supported Devices:** Desktop, POS Kiosk, Tablet
Recommended Browsers: Google Chrome, Microsoft Edge, Safari	**Hardware Compatibility:** USB/BT Scanners, 58mm/80mm Thermal Printers
Document Status: Complete / PDF-Ready	**Last Updated:** August 2026

📑 Table of Contents

1. Getting Started & Authentication
2. Point of Sale (POS) Standalone Terminal
3. 2.1 Full-Screen Terminal Interface
4. 2.2 Barcode Scanning & Hardware Setup
5. 2.3 Keyboard Shortcuts Reference
6. 2.4 POS Terminal Configuration Settings
7. 2.5 Fast Cash, Tender Splitting & Thermal Receipts
8. 2.6 Cart Hold & Retrieve Queue
9. Sales & Invoicing Workflows
10. 3.1 Tax Invoices
11. 3.2 Quotations & Estimates
12. 3.3 Delivery Challans & Packing Slips
13. 3.4 Sales Returns (Credit Notes) & Purchase Returns (Debit Notes)
14. Inventory & Warehouse Management
15. 4.1 Adding Products & Dual Unit Conversion
16. 4.2 Batch & Expiry Date Tracking (FEFO)
17. 4.3 Serial Number / IMEI Tracking
18. 4.4 Stock Adjustments & Damage/Waste Logging
19. 4.5 Multi-Godowns & Inter-Branch Stock Transfers
20. 4.6 Barcode & QR Label Designer
21. Accounting, Ledgers & Banking
22. 5.1 Cash Book & Multi-Bank Accounts
23. 5.2 Contra Entries (Account Transfers)
24. 5.3 Expense Tracker with GST ITC Claims
25. 5.4 Payment In (Customer Receipts) & Payment Out (Vendor Payouts)
26. 5.5 Customer & Supplier Directory with Party Ledgers
27. GST Compliance, E-Way Bills & E-Invoicing
28. 6.1 GSTR-1 Return Filing Tables & JSON Export
29. 6.2 GSTR-3B Consolidated Summary
30. 6.3 NIC E-Way Bill JSON Generator
31. 6.4 B2B E-Invoicing (IRN & Signed QR)
32. Business Reports & Financial Intelligence
33. 7.1 Profit & Loss Statement
34. 7.2 Balance Sheet
35. 7.3 Bill-wise Profit Margins
36. 7.4 Receivables & Payables Ageing (30/60/90 Days)

37. Digital Storefront & Online Orders
38. 8.1 Public Mini Web Shop
39. 8.2 Online & WhatsApp Order Processing
40. 8.3 WhatsApp Payment Reminders with UPI QR
41. 8.4 Discount Coupons & Promotional Schemes
42. System Settings, Backup & Team Access
43. 9.1 Company Profile & GST Settings
44. 9.2 Bank Details for Dynamic Invoice QR Codes
45. 9.3 1-Click Sample Business Data Seeder
46. 9.4 Full JSON Database Backup & Restore
47. 9.5 Staff Roles & Permissions (RBAC)

---

1. Getting Started & Authentication

1.1 Accessing the Application

1. Navigate to your Covinventory application URL in any modern web browser (Google Chrome, Microsoft Edge, Safari, or Mozilla Firefox).
2. Enter your registered **Email Address** and **Password**.
3. Click **Login to Workspace**.
4. Based on your assigned role (Super Admin, Admin, Cashier, Accountant, Warehouse Manager, or Staff), the system directs you to your authorized dashboard workspace.

1.2 Multi-Tenant Workspace Verification

- In the top navigation title bar, verify that your active company name is displayed (e.g. Apex Retail & Traders > Dashboard).
- The system logically isolates all customer records, invoices, accounts, and inventory stock to your specific company identifier (companyId).

---

2. Point of Sale (POS) Standalone Terminal

Route: /pos

The POS module opens in a **dedicated, standalone, full-screen retail counter view** (100vw × 100vh) with no distracting sidebars. It is designed for ultra-fast checkout workflows with barcode scanners, touchscreen category grids, and split payments.

2.1 Full-Screen Terminal Interface

- **Exit POS:** Click **Exit POS** in the top left to return to the management dashboard.
- **Terminal Status:** Displays live online connection status and current cashier name.
- **Live Digital Clock:** Real-time clock and date display (HH:mm:ss · DD MMM YYYY).

- **Fullscreen Kiosk Mode:** Click the **Maximize** icon in the navbar to enter full-screen counter mo### 2.2 Barcode Scanning & Hardware Setup

  Covinventory supports all standard **USB, Bluetooth, and Wireless (2.4GHz)** plug-and-play barcode scanners (acting as standard HID keyboard input devices).

How Scanning Works:

1. **Zero-Click Global Scanning (Hands-Free):** Point your scanner at any product barcode anywhere on the screen without clicking into a search field.
2. The background event listener intercepts high-speed keystrokes (<60ms interval + trailing Enter).
3. Searches inventory by **Barcode** → **SKU** → **Product Name** → **Unique Partial Match**.
4. Plays a synthesized **Audio Beep** on successful match.
5. Adds the item to the cart (or increments quantity by +1).
6. Alerts with an out-of-stock warning if inventory is insufficient.
7. **Hotkey Focus (F2):** Press **F2** on your keyboard to focus the search box for manual barcode typing or name searches. Press **Enter** to add the matched item to the cart.

2.3 Keyboard Shortcuts Reference

Hotkey	Function	Operational Description
`F2`	Focus Search / Scanner	Instantly focuses the product search and barcode input field.
`F4`	Pay & Tender	Opens the tender split-payment modal (Cash, UPI QR, Card).
`F7`	Hold Cart	Puts the active cart on hold and queues it in the top navbar.
`F9`	Quick Cash Checkout	Executes 1-click exact cash checkout, creates invoice record, and prints receipt.
`Esc`	Close / Return	Closes any open modal dialog and refocuses the active cart.

2.4 POS Terminal Configuration Settings (⚙️)

Click the **Settings (⚙️)** icon on the POS top navbar to configure:

- **Default Receipt Format:** Choose between **Thermal POS Printer (80mm / 3-inch)**, **Compact Thermal Printer (58mm / 2-inch)**, or **Standard Desktop A4 / A5**.
- **Auto-Print on Checkout:** Automatically triggers the system print dialog when a sale is completed.
- **Barcode Audio Beep:** Toggle Web Audio API synthesized audio tone on item scan/addition.
- **Fast Cash Presets:** Show/hide quick denomination buttons (₹100, ₹200, ₹500, Exact).

2.5 Bill Generation, Tender Splitting & Receipts

1. **Instant Bill Generation:** Completing checkout (via **F9** or **F4**) instantly saves the transaction in the `sales` collection with an official invoice number (e.g. `POS-123456`) and auto-deducts inventory.
2. **Sale Receipt Modal:** Opens immediately with store header, GSTIN, itemized quantities & prices, discounts, GST breakdown, payment method, and thank you footer.

3. **Multi-Tender Splitting:** Settle bills across multiple modes (e.g., ₹500 Cash + ₹750 UPI QR + ₹1,000 Card).
4. **Dynamic UPI QR Code:** Generates an on-screen UPI QR code encoded with your company UPI ID and the exact grand total for zero-error digital collection.

2.6 Cart Hold & Retrieve Queue

- If a customer needs to pick more items, press **F7** or click **Hold**. The cart is saved with timestamp and customer name.
- Click any held cart badge (#1, #2) in the top navbar to resume billing that customer at any time.

---

3. Sales & Invoicing Workflows

3.1 Creating a Tax Invoice

Route: /sales/new

1. Enter Customer details (Name, Phone, Address, GSTIN).
2. Select invoice items from the dropdown or scan barcodes.
3. Tax (CGST + SGST or IGST) is automatically detected based on the customer's state vs. your company state.
4. Set Payment Mode (Cash, UPI, Bank Transfer, Cheque, Due/Credit).
5. Click **Generate Invoice**. You can share via WhatsApp or download PDF.

3.2 Quotations & Estimates

Route: /quotations

- Generate formal price estimates for prospective buyers.
- When the customer approves the quote, click **Convert to Invoice** to instantly turn it into an active sales invoice without re-typing.

3.3 Delivery Challans & Packing Slips

Route: /challans

- Record goods dispatch for transport without affecting ledger balances immediately.
- Enter vehicle number, driver name, and transport destination.
- Once confirmed delivered, click **Convert to Invoice** to record the financial sale.

3.4 Sales Returns (Credit Notes) & Purchase Returns (Debit Notes)

Route: /returns

- **Sales Return (Credit Note):** Select the original sales invoice, choose returned items and quantities. The system automatically restocks the items into inventory and credits the customer's account balance or records a cash refund.
- **Purchase Return (Debit Note):** Select the original purchase bill, choose returned items. Stock is deducted and vendor payable balance is adjusted automatically.

4. Inventory & Warehouse Management

4.1 Adding Products & Dual Unit Conversion

Route: /inventory

1. Click **Add Product**.
2. Enter Product Name, Brand, SKU, Barcode, Category, Subcategory, and HSN/SAC code.
3. Select the **Base Unit** (e.g. pcs).
4. (Optional) Choose a **Secondary Unit** (e.g. box) and specify the conversion rate (e.g. 1 Box = 12 pcs).
5. Set Buying Price, Selling Price, and GST Rate slab (0%, 5%, 12%, 18%, 28%).
6. Enter opening stock and low stock alert threshold.

4.2 Batch & Expiry Date Tracking (FEFO)

1. In the product form, check **Enable Batch & Expiry Date Tracking**.
2. Enter the **Batch Number**, **Manufacturing Date**, and **Expiry Date**.
3. In the inventory table, items expiring within 30 days receive an amber **"Expiring in X days"** badge, and expired items receive a red **"Expired"** warning.

4.3 Serial Number / IMEI Tracking

- Check **Serial Number / IMEI Tracking** to record individual serial identifiers (comma-separated) for high-value electronics.

4.4 Stock Adjustments & Damage Logging

Route: /inventory/adjustments

1. Click **Record Stock Adjustment**.
2. Select the product, choose **Increase (+)** or **Decrease (-)**, and enter the quantity.
3. Select the reason: Damaged / Broken Goods, Expired Goods, Theft / Loss, Physical Audit Variance, or Internal Store Consumption.
4. The system updates stock levels and creates a permanent audit log entry showing before and after quantities.

4.5 Multi-Godowns & Inter-Branch Stock Transfers

Route: /inventory/godowns

- **Add Godowns:** Register physical branch locations, warehouse addresses, and branch managers.
- **Stock Transfer Voucher:** Click **Transfer Stock**, select **Source Godown (From)**, **Destination Godown (To)**, product, and transfer quantity to log stock movement.

4.6 Barcode & QR Label Designer

Route: /inventory/barcodes

1. Select items to print and adjust quantity counts.
2. Select format: **Barcode (Code 128)** or **QR Code**.
3. Choose sheet layout: **Compact (40-Up Sheet)**, **Standard (24-Up Sheet)**, or **Large (12-Up Sheet)**.
4. Toggle MRP price and Company Name visibility.
5. Click **Print Labels** to print bulk sticker sheets.

---

5. Accounting, Ledgers & Banking

5.1 Cash Book & Multi-Bank Accounts

Route: /banking

- Track your liquid funds across **Cash in Hand (Petty Cash)**, **Bank Current/Savings Accounts** (HDFC, SBI, ICICI), and **Digital Wallets** (Paytm, UPI).
- View live account balances and overall liquid cash position.

5.2 Contra Transfers

Route: /banking → Click **Contra Transfer**

- Record transfers between internal accounts:
- **Cash Withdrawal:** Bank to Cash
- **Cash Deposit:** Cash to Bank
- **Inter-Bank Transfer:** Bank A to Bank B

5.3 Expense Tracker with GST ITC

Route: /expenses

1. Click **Record Expense**.
2. Enter Title (e.g. Office Rent, Electricity, Staff Salaries, Logistics & Freight, Software).
3. Enter amount, date, and payment mode.
4. If the expense is eligible for GST Input Tax Credit, check **GST ITC Eligible**, select the tax rate, and enter the vendor GSTIN.

5.4 Payment In & Payment Out Vouchers

Route: /payments

- **Payment In (Receipt):** Record when a customer settles an invoice or makes an advance payment. Updates customer due balance and deposits money into your selected bank/cash register.
- **Payment Out (Payout):** Record vendor payouts against purchase bills.

5.5 Customer & Supplier Directory with Party Ledgers

Route: /customers and /suppliers

- **Credit Limits:** Set a maximum credit ceiling. If a customer exceeds the limit, a warning alert is displayed.
- **Credit Period:** Set payment due terms (e.g. 30 Days Due).
- **Party Ledger Statement:** Click the **Ledger** button next to any party to open their interactive Statement of Account showing all Invoices, Payments, Returns, and a live running **Debit (Dr) / Credit (Cr)** balance.

---

6. GST Compliance, E-Way Bills & E-Invoicing

Route: /gst-reports

6.1 GSTR-1 Return Filing & Table 12 HSN Summary

- **Section 4A (B2B):** Invoices issued to GST-registered businesses.
- **Section 7 (B2C Large & Small):** Inter-state > ₹2.5L and intra-state retail sales to unregistered consumers.
- **Section 9B (CDNR):** Credit and Debit notes issued.
- **Section 12 (HSN-wise Summary of Outward Supplies):**
- Aggregates quantities, taxable values, CGST, SGST, IGST, and total invoice values grouped by HSN code.
- Calculation engine automatically handles multi-item line rates, item discounts, and fallback outward supply codes (`HSN 9988`).
- Click **Download GSTR-1 JSON** to get a verified, portal-ready JSON file for direct upload on gst.gov.in, or click **CSV Export** for spreadsheets.

6.2 GSTR-3B Summary

- Consolidated monthly return summary:
- **Table 3.1 Outward Taxable Supplies:** Total taxable value and tax collected.
- **Table 4 Eligible Input Tax Credit (ITC):** ITC from purchases and ITC-eligible business expenses.
- **Net Tax Payable:** Automatically calculated as Outward Tax minus Eligible ITC.

6.3 NIC E-Way Bill JSON Generator

1. Switch to the **E-Way Bill Generator** tab.
2. Select any invoice with total value > ₹50,000.
3. Enter Transporter Name, Transporter ID, Vehicle Number, and distance in KM.
4. Click **Export E-Way Bill JSON** and upload directly on ewaybillgst.gov.in to generate official E-Way Bill numbers in bulk.

6.4 B2B E-Invoicing (IRN & QR)

- Select a B2B sales invoice and click **Generate E-Invoice IRN & Signed QR** to simulate or generate 64-character hash strings and signed QR images.

---

7. Business Reports & Financial Intelligence

Route: /reports

7.1 Profit & Loss Statement (Income Statement)

- **1. Total Invoiced Sales Revenue (A):** Sum of all completed sales and POS orders.
- **Less: Direct Cost of Goods Sold (COGS):** Total acquisition cost of sold items ($\sum \text{qty} \times \text{buyingPrice}$).
- **GROSS PROFIT:** $\text{Total Revenue} - \text{COGS}$.
- **2. Operating & Administrative Overhead Expenses (B):** Sum of all operational expenses logged in the Expenses module ($\sum \text{expense amount}$).
- **NET PROFIT BEFORE TAX:** $\text{Gross Profit} - \text{Operating Expenses (B)}$.

7.2 Balance Sheet

- **Total Assets:** Liquid Cash & Bank Balances + Inventory Asset Value + Accounts Receivable (Customer Credit).
- **Total Liabilities:** Accounts Payable (Supplier Credit Due).
- **Owner Equity:** $\text{Total Assets} - \text{Total Liabilities}$.

7.3 Bill-wise Profit Margin & Receivables Ageing

- **Bill-wise Margin:** Displays invoice-by-invoice profit and margin percentage.
- **Receivables & Payables Ageing:** Classifies outstanding customer dues into **0-30 Days**, **31-60 Days**, **61-90 Days**, and **90+ Days (Overdue)**.

---

8. Digital Storefront & Online Orders

8.1 Public Mini Web Shop

URL: /store/:companyId or /store

- Share your public store link with your customers via WhatsApp, Instagram, or SMS.
- Customers can browse product photos, filter by category, add items to their cart, and click **Order via WhatsApp** or submit an online order directly.

8.2 Online Order Processing

Route: /orders

- View incoming web/WhatsApp orders.
- Update shipment pipeline: Pending → Accepted → Packed → Shipped → Delivered.
- Click **Convert to Invoice** to turn an online order into a tax invoice and deduct stock automatically.

8.3 WhatsApp Payment Reminders with UPI QR

Route: /marketing

1. Select any customer with pending dues.
2. The system automatically creates a polite WhatsApp message with their exact balance and an embedded live **UPI Instant Payment Link** (using your configured UPI ID).

3. Click **Open in WhatsApp & Send Reminder** to launch WhatsApp Web/App with pre-filled text.

8.4 Promotional Coupons

Route: /marketing → **Discount Coupons & Schemes**

- Create percentage or flat amount discount coupon codes (e.g. SAVE10, FESTIVE500) with minimum order value and expiry date constraints.

---

9. System Settings, Backup & Team Access

Route: /settings

9.1 Company Profile & GST Configuration

- Enter Business Name, Official Address, Phone, Email, Logo Image URL, and default Terms & Conditions.
- Configure your **GSTIN**, **Operating State**, and tax scheme (**Regular** vs. **Composition**).

9.2 Bank Details for Invoice QR Codes

- Enter your **UPI ID (VPA)** (e.g. merchant@okhdfcbank). Every invoice generated will automatically include a dynamic UPI QR code that customers can scan using Google Pay, PhonePe, or Paytm.
- Enter Bank Name, Account Number, and IFSC code for wire transfer printing.

9.3 1-Click Sample Business Data Seeder

- Under **Settings** → **Backup & Restore**, click **Populate Sample Business Data**.
- Instantly seeds demo products, sales, purchases, expenses, bank accounts, godowns, and customers across all 15 Firestore collections for effortless evaluation.

9.4 Full Database Backup & Restore

- **Export Backup:** Click **Export Full Database Backup (JSON)** to download a complete, timestamped JSON snapshot containing all products, invoices, purchases, parties, expenses, accounts, challans, returns, and godowns.
- **Restore from Backup:** Select a previously downloaded JSON file to restore or migrate your entire business database in seconds.

9.5 Staff Roles & Permissions (RBAC Matrix)

Module / Feature	Staff / Cashier Role	Admin Role	Super Admin Role
POS Billing (/pos)	✅ Full Access	✅ Full Access	✅ Full Access
Sales & Invoices (/sales)	✅ Create & View Invoices	✅ Full Access	✅ Full Access
Quotations & Challans	✅ Create & Convert	✅ Full Access	✅ Full Access
Credit & Debit Notes	✅ Create & Restock	✅ Full Access	✅ Full Access
Products & Barcodes	✅ Catalog & Label Print	✅ Full Access	✅ Full Access

Module / Feature	Staff / Cashier Role	Admin Role	Super Admin Role
Purchases & Expenses	✅ Record Inward & Overheads	✅ Full Access	✅ Full Access
Payment In & Out (/payments)	✅ Record Vouchers	✅ Full Access	✅ Full Access
Executive Dashboard (/)	🔒 Restricted	✅ Full Access	✅ Full Access
Financial Reports & P&L (/reports)	🔒 Restricted	✅ Full Access	✅ Full Access
GST Returns & E-Way (/gst-reports)	🔒 Restricted	✅ Full Access	✅ Full Access
Cash & Bank Accounts (/banking)	🔒 Restricted	✅ Full Access	✅ Full Access
System Settings & RBAC (/settings)	🔒 Restricted	✅ Full Access	✅ Full Access
Multi-Tenant Admin (/superadmin)	🔒 Restricted	🔒 Restricted	✅ Full Access